Sensing the Future

How AI-era marketing teams use sight, sound, scent, touch, taste and the new sense of context to build memory, preference and loyalty.

Vision

Adaptive screens, AR try-on

Hearing

Sonic logos, voice AI

Smell

Signature scents, digital diffusion

Touch

Haptics, texture tech

Taste

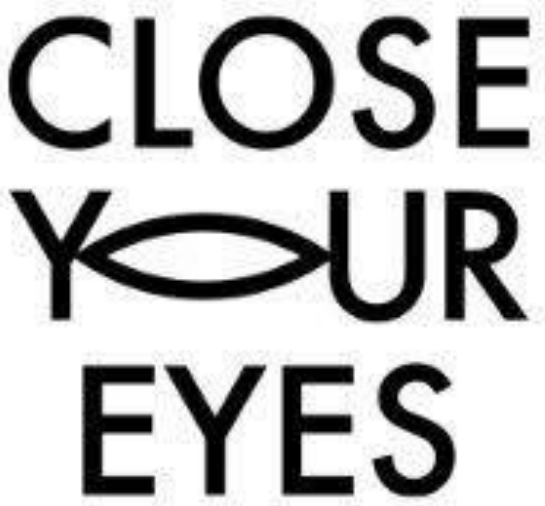
AI flavour labs

Context

Mind, memory, AI cognition

Which sound created the strongest emotion? Why?

If your brand had to pick ONE sound to own, what would it erase or replace in your customers' day?



How could AI generate a *personalised* sonic signature for each customer segment?

The behavioural case

Why sensory marketing wins the consumer

Senses are the shortest route from stimulus to emotion to memory and purchase decisions are made there first.

~90%

of purchase decisions are driven by subconscious, emotional processing rather than deliberate reasoning (Zaltman, 2003; Lindstrom, 2008).

65% vs 10%

People recall visual content three days later at 65%, versus ~10% for text alone (HubSpot visual content research).

+30%

Revenue uplift reported by brands engaging three or more senses in experience design, versus one-sense branding (Lindstrom, Brand Sense, 2005).

"We feel before we think. Brands that design for the senses design for memory and memory is where preference lives."

paraphrased from Krishna (2012), Journal of Consumer Psychology

Framework

The sensory consumer-behaviour loop

Classical perception theory, now instrumented: AI touches every stage.

1 · Stimulus

Sight, sound, scent, touch, taste designed or ambient

2 · Perception

AI role: computer vision, audio & sentiment analysis read reaction in real time

3 · Emotion

AI role: affect detection tunes intensity, pace, and modality

4 · Memory

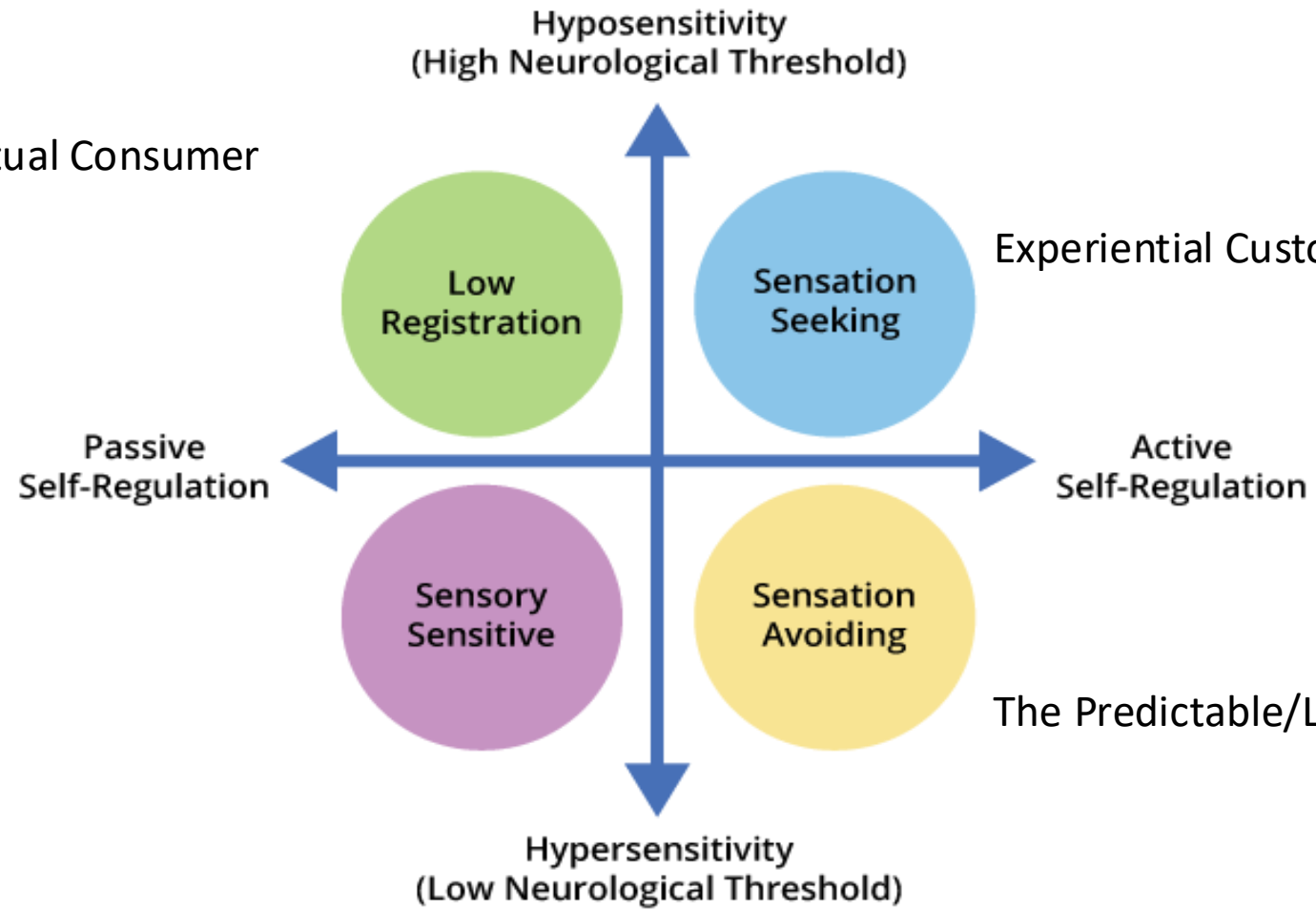
Distinctive sensory codes become brand memory structures

5 · Behaviour

Choice, loyalty, advocacy measured and fed back into stimulus design

Dinnie Dunn's Model of Sensory Processing

The Habitual Consumer



Experiential Customer



The Predictable/Loyal Consumer

The Analytical & Detracted Consumer


nutella

The shelf that watches back

In market now

- **Nutella Unica (Italy):** an algorithm generated 7 million unique jar designs. Sold out in ~30 days each jar became a shareable visual object.
- **Amazon Fresh & Walmart:** dynamic shelf-edge screens swap pricing and promo by time of day, footfall and basket data.
- **Warby Parker:** AR try-on in its app converts browsing to purchase by removing the 'fit uncertainty' barrier in eyewear.

On the roadmap

- **Emotion-adaptive displays:** screens that read dwell time and facial response to re-rank what they show.
- **AI 'store of one':** planograms rebuilt per shopper segment, per hour.
- **AR as default**: beauty, furniture and auto already piloting camera-first commerce.

Ask the room: when does personalised visual merchandising become surveillance?



Vision 2030 from display to dialogue

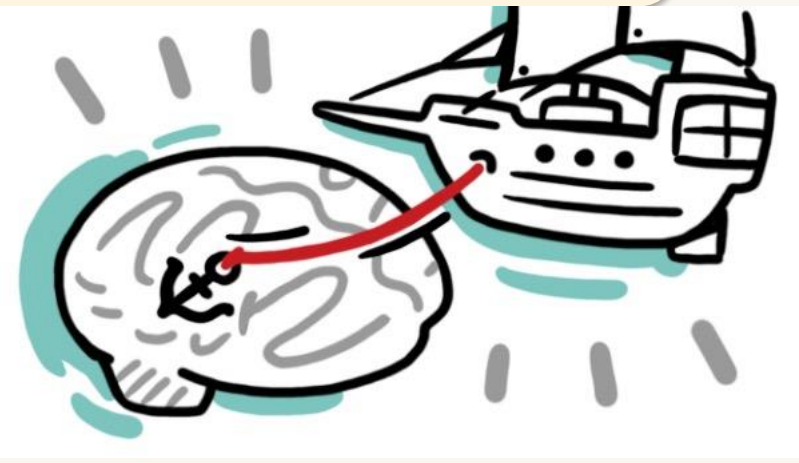
Generative packaging at scale

Beyond Nutella: every SKU could carry a unique visual identity generated from purchase occasion data, collapsing the gap between mass production and one-to-one design.

Biometric-aware windows

Retail facades that shift creative based on aggregate mood, weather and traffic the billboard becomes a live conversation.

Memory hook: People retain ~65% of visual information after three days vs ~10% of text pairing visual with another sense multiplies that effect.





Why Netflix's ta-dum sound is so iconic

Less than three seconds for the age of "click and play"

Evokes "entertainment" rather than "software" like Xbox or Mac

Builds tension and releases it, like a good movie

Doesn't sound like a recognizable instrument

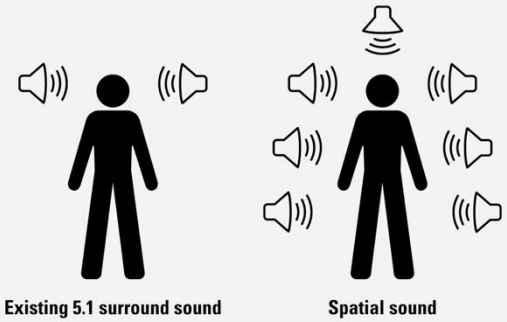
The three-second brand real-world cases

In market now

- **Netflix 'ta-dum':** one of the most recognisable sonic logos in the world, designed to trigger anticipation in under 3 seconds.
- **Mastercard**: dropped its name from the logo and built a full sonic brand architecture melody for ads, point-of-sale sounds, ringtones.
- **Starbucks:** licenses and curates playlists to match daypart and mood, turning the store into a branded audio environment.
- **McDonald's** 'I'm lovin' it': a five-note mnemonic that travels across 100+ markets with near-universal recall.

On the roadmap

- **Adaptive soundscapes:** store audio that shifts tempo and genre in response to real-time crowd emotion and queue length.
- **Voice-first commerce**: assistants that hold your brand voice, accent and emotional register.
- **Spatial audio AR:** audio anchors in physical space hear the promotion when you walk past the shelf.



Hearing 2030 from background to brand voice

AI-composed brand music

Generative audio tools can now produce infinite variations of a sonic logo, each adapted to channel, time of day and local culture without losing identity.

Silence as a design choice

As audio saturation grows, intentional quiet the Apple Store hush, the luxury boutique stillness becomes a sonic differentiator.

"Sound is processed in the same brain regions as emotion and memory. A three-second mnemonic can outlast a million-dollar campaign image."

Jackson & Jankovich, Sonic Branding (2019)


SINGAPORE AIRLINES
SINGAPORE AIRLINES



The most memory-linked, least digitised sense real cases

In market now

- **Singapore Airlines:** 'Stefan Floridian Waters' a signature scent worn by crew and infused into cabins, consistently ranked in brand-experience lists.
- **Abercrombie & Fitch:** its Fierce fragrance was pumped through stores to anchor the brand to a specific teen demographic and mood.
- **Disney:** pumped vanilla scent on Main Street USA and baking smells near confectionery windows to extend dwell time.
- **Lush:** unpackaged products make the shop smell the advertising scent is the primary media plan.

On the roadmap

- **Digital scent:** AI models of molecular structure (e.g. Osmo) promise scent that can be generated, transmitted and printed.
- **Scent wearables for VR**: headsets with scent cartridges for immersive retail and training.
- **Programmable scent zones**: HVAC-integrated diffusion that changes by aisle, hour, or even shopper profile.

Smell 2030 from ambience to data layer

Scent-as-code

If digital scent transmission becomes viable, brands could email a fragrance sample or deliver a 'new car smell' with a vehicle configurator.

Olfactory personalisation

Scent profiles linked to loyalty data the coffee shop that smells different for the morning commuter versus the afternoon remote worker.

Memory hook: Herz (2004) showed smell is the sense most directly wired to emotional memory yet hardest to deliver digitally. That tension is the opportunity.

Tanvas

Slide to feel each texture

Choppy

Grainy

Fine

Wavy

kindle scribe

Where ideas grow



11" front-lit display

Paper-like feel

AI for your notes

Easily import documents

Closing the haptic gap real-world cases

In market now

- **Apple unboxing:** friction curves, matte-black paper, magnetic lids each touchpoint is measured to signal precision and care.
- **Dyson:** material honesty (robust plastics, soft-touch finishes) tells the engineering story before the motor is turned on.
- **Samsung:** haptic feedback language in Galaxy devices carries brand identity through vibration patterns.
- **Tanvas: texture** screens let shoppers 'feel' fabric on a tablet, used in apparel retail pilots.

On the roadmap

- **Haptic gloves:** SenseGlove and Meta research let shoppers feel products in VR fitting rooms.
- **Programmable materials:** packaging and surfaces that change texture on cue.
- **Touch telepresence: remote** 'feel before you buy' for e-commerce's biggest sensory deficit.

Touch 2030 from surface to signal

Packaging as interface

Surfaces that warm, cool or texture-shift based on delivery timing or user context the box becomes part of the product experience.

Haptic search

Online browsing with texture feedback for fabric, finish and weight reducing the return-rate penalty of touch-free shopping.

Memory hook: Peck & Childers (2003) found touch before purchase increases perceived ownership and valuation — the 'endowment effect' begins at the fingertip.

Coca-Cola

Y3000 AI CAM







FUTURE FLAVOR UNLEASHED: THE Y3000 VISION

COCA-COLA'S Y3000 CAMPAIGN INTRODUCED A LIMITED EDITION FLAVOR AND THE INNOVATIVE Y3000 AI CAM, AN AI-POWERED FEATURE OFFERING FUTURISTIC VISUAL EXPERIENCES. THE GOAL WAS TO GENERATE BUZZ AND ENGAGEMENT THROUGH A UNIQUE, AI-DRIVEN CONCEPT ACCESSIBLE GLOBALLY ACROSS 30+ MARKETS. THE CAMPAIGN FOCUSED ON A SEAMLESS, ENGAGING USER JOURNEY: SCANNING A COKE PRODUCT TO UNLOCK THE AI CAM, TRANSFORMING SURROUNDINGS INTO FUTURISTIC VISUALS, AND SHARING THESE PERSONALIZED VISIONS ON SOCIAL MEDIA.

CRAFTING THE FUTURE: NARRATIVES, TECH, AND TRIUMPHS

THE STRATEGY CENTERED ON A COMPELLING NARRATIVE AND INTUITIVE INTERACTION, EMPHASIZING PERSONALIZATION AND SOCIAL SHARING. CHALLENGES LIKE CULTURAL ADAPTATION AND TECHNOLOGICAL SCALABILITY WERE OVERCOME THROUGH METICULOUS TESTING AND CUSTOMIZATION.

SPECTACULAR SUCCESS: Y3000'S GLOBAL IMPACT

RESULTS WERE OUTSTANDING, ACHIEVING WIDESPREAD ENGAGEMENT AND POSITIVE RECEPTION:

5.2B
Earned Media Impressions

#1
AI Activation of 2023 by AdAge

693K
New Visitors to Coke Hub

The AI flavour lab real-world cases

In market now

- **Coca-Cola Y3000:** generative AI predicted flavours consumers would love in a 'future' context launched as a limited drop with social conversation baked in.

- **Heinz A.I. Ketchup**: used AI image-to-concept to explore what ketchup could look like, then taste-tested the most promising outputs.

- **Nespresso: flavour** profiling and machine learning guide pod recommendations based on past purchases and time-of-day patterns.

- **Häagen-Dazs:** in-store sampling tied to weather data ice cream flavours pushed on hot days through geo-targeted promos.

On the roadmap

- **Computational flavour design**: models mapping molecular combinations to emotional response, not just taste.

- **Taste-digital crossover:** electric taste interfaces for remote tasting demos.

- **Food as media**: limited AI-designed drops engineered for social conversation as much as palate.

Taste 2030 from recipe to resonance

Emotion-first flavour

AI models that predict how a flavour makes people feel calm, energised, nostalgic rather than just how it tastes.

Hyper-local drops

AI-generated limited editions tuned to city-level cultural moments, launched and sold out in 48-hour windows.

Memory hook: Taste is inseparable from context the same wine scores higher when accompanied by heavier cutlery (Spence et al.). Context is the hidden ingredient.





Roll over image to zoom in
Share your own customer images

Rucanor Aluminium Baseball Bat

by Rucanor

★★★★☆ (29 customer reviews)

RRP: ~~£21.00~~
Price: £18.40 & **FREE Delivery** in the UK. Details
You Save: £2.60 (12%)

Colour: **Silver**

Size: 60

In stock.
Sold by MA sports uk and Fulfilled by Amazon. Gift-wrap available.

- 60 CM BASEBALL BAT
- ALUMINIUM Alloy

5 new from £14.40

Quantity: 1

Add to Basket
or 1-Click Checkout
Buy now with 1-Click®

This is a gift

Add to Wish List

More Buying Choices

ANDRA SPORTS Add to Basket
£14.40 + £3.99 UK delivery

sportknox Add to Basket
£17.45 + £3.99 UK delivery

5 new from £14.40

Have one to sell? Sell yours here

Share

Frequently Bought Together



Price For Both: £28.39

Add both to Basket

Show availability and delivery details

- **This item:** Rucanor Aluminium Baseball Bat, Silver - 60 cm £18.40
- WILSON Official League Individual Baseball £9.99

Customers Who Bought This Item Also Bought

Page 1 of 18



REYDON Softball Ball
★★★★★★ (1)
£3.99



MFH Balaclava 3 Hole Black
★★★★☆ (94)
£1.74



New Midwest Slugger Baseball Glove Vinyl Catching Mitt Left Hand Junior / Senior



Rawlings 9" Indoor / Outdoor T-Ball Training Baseball - TVB
★★★★½ (3)



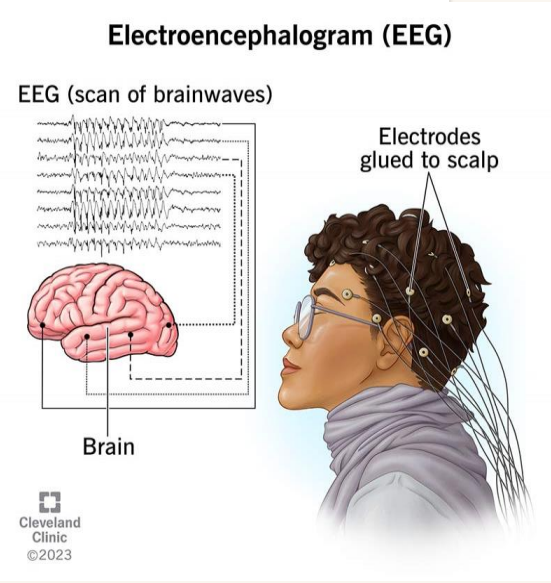
The sense AI made real-world cases

In market now

- **Spotify AI DJ:** combines recommendation data with a synthetic voice to create a personalised radio host — context (time, mood, history) becomes content.
- **TikTok algorithm:** watches micro-behaviour (dwell, rewatch, share) to infer emotional state and serve the next dopamine-calibrated video.
- **Nike Run Club:** adapts coaching audio to pace, weather and calendar context the product becomes a situational companion.
- **Amazon:** 'customers also bought' and anticipatory shipping turn purchase history into a predictive context layer.

On the roadmap

- **Context-aware retail**: stores that sense situation and knowledge state (with consent) and adapt every sense.
- **Affective computing**: real-time emotion detection tuning music, lighting and scent in a shop.
- **Neuromarketing scale**: EEG and eye-tracking move from lab to live environment.



Context 2030 from segment to individual

The segment of one, physical

Retail environments that reconfigure sensory mix (light, sound, scent) based on your loyalty profile, time since last visit, and real-time biometrics (opt-in).

Knowledge-state marketing

Systems that detect whether you are browsing, comparing, or ready to buy and shift message depth and modality accordingly.

"The most sophisticated sense is not smell or taste it is the sense of what someone needs right now. AI is building that."

paraphrased from industry commentary on contextual intelligence

Case study

Apple a sensory ecosystem, not just a product

Apple does not rely on one sense. It orchestrates all five plus context into a single, coherent memory structure.

Vision

Clean white stores, uniform lighting, product-as-sculpture displays. Every pixel of packaging is designed.

Touch

Matte-black paper, magnetic lid snap, aluminium coolness — unboxing is a choreographed tactile event.

Sound

The Mac startup chime, AirPods connection tone, silence in stores. Each sound is a confirmation of quality.

Smell

The 'new Mac' smell a mix of materials and manufacturing has become a nostalgic trigger for owners.

Context

iCloud, Handoff, and AI recommendations knit devices into a seamless knowledge layer around the user.

Result

One of the highest brand-equity scores globally, built on sensory consistency as much as engineering.

Inside a real marketing team

The sensory experience design loop

1 · Data

Basket, dwell, clickstream, social, neurometric signals

2 · AI insight

Clustering finds the emotional 'job to be done' per segment

3 · Sensory concept

Brand codes designed across sight / sound / scent / touch

4 · Phygital test

Flagship store + A/B digital twins measure response

5 · Learn

Creative feedback loop — experience versioned like software

Starbucks

Store design, playlist licensing and roastery smell combine with Deep Brew AI personalisation in-app sensory theatre plus algorithmic intimacy.

Lush

"Naked" unpackaged products make touch and smell the entire media plan proof a sensory code can replace advertising spend.

Interactive · class activity

The sensory explorer

A rapid-fire 'now vs next' for each sense. Split the room into teams, assign one sense per team, and have them pitch the 2030 version.

Vision	Hearing	Smell	Touch	Taste	Mind & context
Adaptive screens, AR try-on	Sonic logos, voice AI	Signature scents, digital diffusion	Haptics, texture tech	AI flavour labs	Mind, memory, AI cognition

Now

Dynamic shelf-edge screens, AI-generated packaging (Nutella Unica: 7M unique jars), per-user ad creative at scale.

Next

Emotion-adaptive displays and AR try-on as the default path to purchase; store layouts re-optimised hourly by AI.

Memory hook: people retain ~65% of visual information after 3 days vs ~10% of text (HubSpot).

Wrap-up

Key takeaways & references

Takeaways

• Senses buy memory; AI buys timing and personalisation. The winners combine both.

• Sound and scent are the most under-priced brand codes relative to their memory impact.

• Touch is e-commerce's biggest deficit — haptics is the investment to watch.

• Context (knowledge + situation) is now a designed sensory input, not an accident.

• Sensory power raises manipulation stakes — ethics is a design requirement, not a footnote.

Core references

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Market figures are indicative of widely-cited industry research; verify latest numbers before citation in assessed work.